Movement across finite clause boundaries

The case of hyper raising in Brazilian Portuguese

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Hyper raising is a cross clausal dependency across a finite clause boundary

Baseline: argument DPs in situ at the embedded clause

Parece	que	**a Julia**	tratou	mal	**as**	**meninas**
Seem.3SG	that	the Julia	treat.3SG.PST	bad	the.PL	girls

"It seems Julia was rude to the girls."

Hyper raising: embedded arguments emerge at the main clause

Hyper-raising in BP

a. **A Julia** parece [que __ tratou mal as meninas]
The Julia seem.3SG that __ treat.3SG.PST bad the.PL girls

b. **As meninas** parecem/parece [que a Julia tratou mal __]
The.PL girls seem.PL/seem.SG that the Julia treat.3SG.PST bad __
"It seems Julia was rude to the girls."

What is the nature of the dependency between matrix DP and the embedded gap?

A	**Julia**	parece	que	tratou	mal	**as**	**meninas**
The	Julia	seem.3SG	that	treat.3SG.PST	bad	the.PL	girls

Movement?
Base generation?

Hyper raising is movement

It is not possible out of islands

HR is banned from complex DP islands.

a. Parece que a delegada ouviu [o depoimento de que a Julia tratou mal **aquelas meninas**]
Seem.SG that the deputy.F hear.3SG.PST the report of that the Julia treat.3SG.PST bad those.F girls

b. *__Aquelas meninas__$_i$ parecem que a delegada ouviu [o depoimento de que a Julia tratou mal __$_i$]
Those.F girls seem.PL that the deputy.F hear.3SG.PST the report of that the Julia treat.3SG.PST bad __
"It seems the deputy heard the report that Julia was rude to those girls."

Hyper raising is movement (with A-properties)

It maintains idiomatic readings

HR out of an idiom chunk maintains the idiomatic reading (Nunes, 2008)

a. Parece que a vaca foi para o brejo
Seems that the cow go.3SG.PST to the bog

b. A vaca parece que _ foi para o brejo
the cow seems that _ go.3SG.PST to the bog
"It seems *things didn't go well.*", lit "It seems the cow went into the bog".

Hyper raising is movement (with A-properties)

It feeds into A-binding

HR DP may provide a new antecedent for binding

a. *Em **suas**$_i$ próprias casas parece [que a Julia tratou
In their.F.PL own.F.PL houses.PL.F seem.3PL that the Julia treat.3SG.PST
mal **as** **meninas**]
bad the.PL girls

b. **As** **meninas**$_i$ [em **suas**$_i$ próprias casas] parecem que a
The.PL girls in their.F.PL own.F.PL houses.PL.F seem.3PL that the
Julia tratou mal __
Julia treat.3SG.PST bad __
"It seems that Julia was rude to the girls in their own homes."

Hyper raising is movement

It allows reconstructed scope readings

HR is tied to scope ambiguity

a. Parece que **duas pessoas** ganharam a loteria
Seem.3SG that two.F people.PL win.3PL.PST the lottery
"It seems like two people won the lottery".
➡ * Two > seem, seem > two

b. **Duas pessoas** parecem que _ ganharam a loteria
Two.F people.PL seem.3PL that _ win.3PL.PST the lottery
"Two people seem like they won the lottery".
➡ Two > seem, seem > two

Islands
Idioms
A-binding
Reconstruction

→

Movement
With A-properties

Movement from a finite clause boundary raises 4 theoretical issues

Finite clauses are phase boundaries

- Movement from a phase requires movement to the edge
- A finite clause is a complete phase domain
- No transparent mechanism for moving out of it (i.e., case)
- Compare: standard raising (non-finite embedded clause) vs. hyper raising

A-movement out of a clause boundary violates the ban on Improper Movement

- Movement from a phase requires movement to the edge
- The edge of a clause is SpecCP
- SpecCP is an A’-position
- Hyper raising lands in an A-position
- A’-A chain is improper movement

Hyper raising is optional A-movement

- If A-movement is strictly motivated how can it be optional?

Hyper raising moves DPs inactive for movement

- A finite clause is a complete phase domain
- DPs have all of their features checked (case, phi-features)
- DPs are rendered inactive for movement

How to account for the four issues?

- Phase boundaries
- Improper movement
- Optionality
- Activity

Proposal in a nutshell

HR is the result of:

- DP internal properties
- Discourse driven movement

Proposal in a nutshell

- DPs in BP carry a hyperactive feature (Carstens 2009, 2016)
- HR verbs in BP carry a discursive (δ) feature probe driving discursive movement (Miyagawa 2009, 2012)
- δ is special, it agrees with two things:
  - The embedded CP, unlocking the clause boundary (Van Urk 2015)
  - The hyperactive DP

Part I: Hyperactive DPs

Number is a hyperactive feature in BP

- Carstens 2016: grammatical gender in Bantu is [-interpretable, +valued], always active for movement and agree.
- Claim: in BP number is a grammatical feature, [-interpretable, +valued].
- Why?
  - Loss of DP internal plural concord
  - Optional number agreement
  - Widespread semantically plural bare singulars
  - Plurality as a property of D

DPs in Brazilian Portuguese carry a [-interpretable, +valued] feature on D, this feature is [num]

Part II: discursive movement

HR verbs carry a δ probe (Miyagawa 2009, 2017, 2022)

- δ drives discursive movement
- δ targets [num] on D and discursive features on CP
- Why? Discursive movement in BP:
  - Optional
  - Information structure driven
  - Impersonal verbal predicates
- (Other instances of optional discursive movement in BP: topic-subjects, locative inversion (Pontes, 1987; Avelar and Galves, 2011, 2014; Avelar and Cyrino, 2018; de Andrade and Galves, 2014) and wh-movement)

Hyper raising is an instance of discursive movement in BP

Hyper raising verbs carry a δ probe that probes lower elements into its local domain

Part III: Phase unlocking

δ unlocks a phase through agree with a CP with unvalued δ features

- How does δ reach the embedded DPs?
- Agreement with the CP (similar to Van Urk 2015)
- HR verbs may c-select either a regular CP or a $_{u\delta}$CP
- $_{u\delta}$CP does not trigger spell-out
- δ agrees with CP, values its *u*δ, then probes DPs through [num]
- CP is rendered inactive for movement
- Phase unlocking is c-selection of a CP that does not trigger spell-out

Part III: Phase Unlocking

HR freezes CPs for movement

a. O gato parece [que _ fugiu]
the cat seems that _ escaped

b. *[Que _ fugiu] o gato parece _
That _ escaped the cat seems _

c. [Que o gato fugiu] parece óbvio _
That the cat escaped seems obvious _
"That the cat ran away seems obvious."

Part III: Phase unlocking

HR verbs carry δ, not all verbs do

Only HR verbs may extract out of phase boundaries

a. O Pedro parece que _ foi pro Paraguai
The Pedro seems that _ went to-the Paraguay
"It seems Pedro went to Paraguay."

b. A Carla disse [que o Pedro parece que _ foi para o Paraguai]
The Carla said that the Pedro seems that _ went to the Paraguay

c. *O Pedro a Carla disse que [_ parece que _ foi para o Paraguai]
The Pedro the Carla said that _ seems that _ went to the Paraguay
"Carla said that it seems Pedro went to Paraguay."

HR v may select for either a CP carrying *uδ* or a regular CP

➡ **$CP_{u\delta}$ does not trigger spellout**

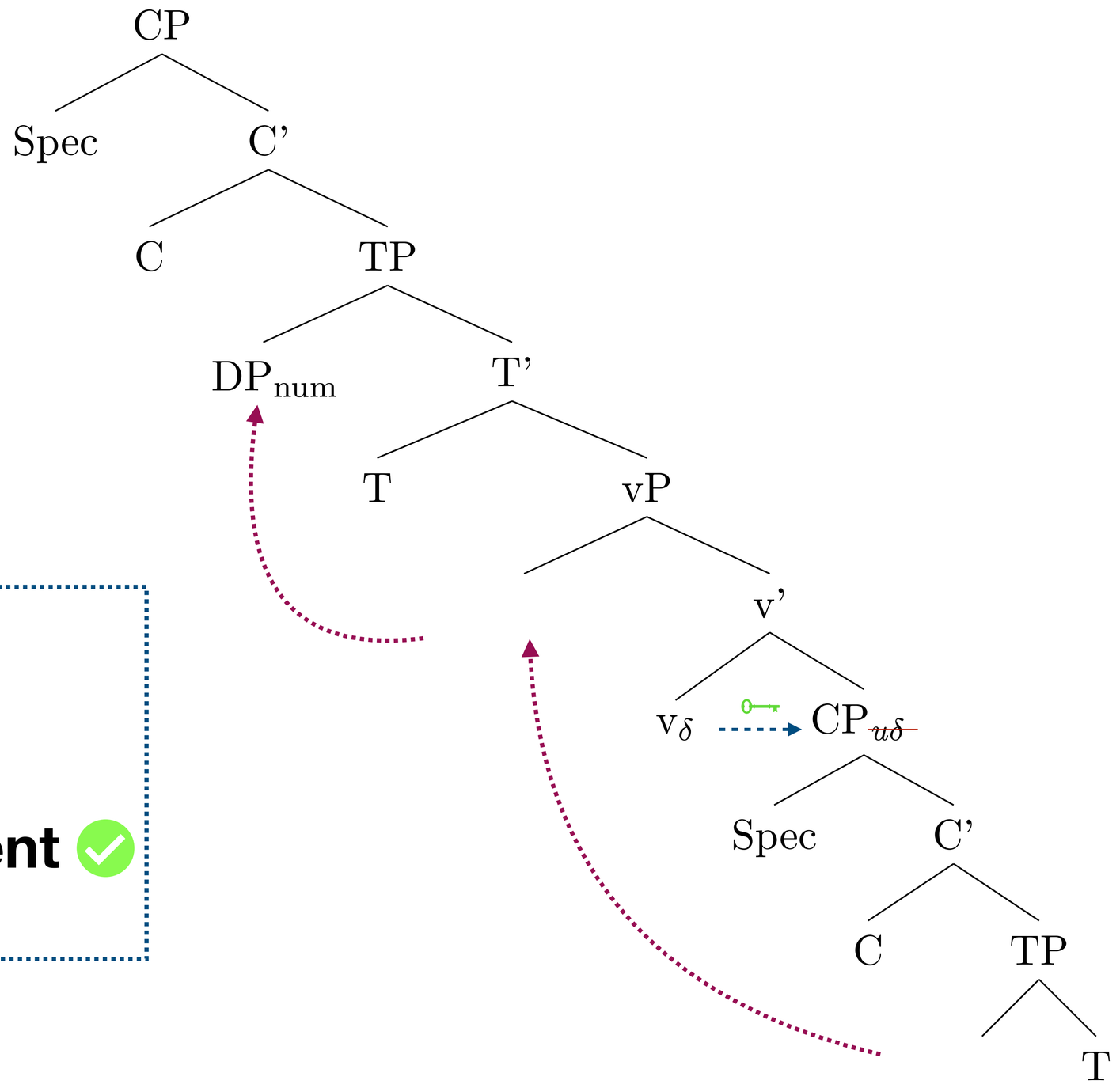
Agree between matrix v (through δ) and the embedded CP unlocks the clause boundary

Putting everything together

Going back:

How is the dependency between matrix DP and embedded gap established?

A	**Julia**	parece	que	tratou	mal	**as**	**meninas**
The	Julia	seem.3SG	that	treat.3SG.PST	bad	the.PL	girls



Issues:

Activity ✓

Phasehood ✓

Improper Movement ✓

Optionality ✓

Predictions

DPs without [num] may not undergo HR

HR requires hyperactivity, [num] is the hyperactive feature

Bare singulars I

a. Ele tratou **criança** mal
He treat.3SG child.F.SG. bad
"He was mean to children."

b. Parece [que ele tratou **criança** mal]
Seem that he treat.3SG child.F.SG bad

c. *__Criança__ parece [que ele tratou $\mathbf{t}_i$ mal]
Child.F.SG seem that he treat.3SG t bad
"It seems he was mean to children."

DPs without [num] may not undergo HR

HR requires hyperactivity, num is the hyperactive feature

Bare singulars II

a. A chefe comprou um carro, **carro** que ela vendeu uma semana
the boss.F bought.3SG one.M car, car that she sold.3SG one.F week
depois
later
"The boss bought a car, a car she sold a week after."

b. *A chefe comprou um carro, **carro** parece que ela vendeu _ uma
the. boss bought.3SG one.M car, car seems that she sold.3SG _ one.F
semana depois
week later
"The boss bought a car, a car that it seems she sold a week after."

A-movement not requiring hyperactivity is fine

Example: passives do not require [num]

Context: you are sitting at a bar with a friend in a small town and your friend points to an old lady - who used to be a well known school teacher - walking by the sidewalk and says:

a. Aquela senhora ensinou muita criança a ler (nessa cidade)
That lady taught many.SG child.SG to read in-this town
"That lady taught many children to read (in this town)"

b. Muita criança foi ensinada a ler por aquela senhora (nessa cidade)
Many.SG child.SG was taught.PART.SG to read by that lady in-this town
"Many children were taught to read by that lady (in this town)."

Non-DPs should not HR

Number on D is a property of DPs

Argument CPs may not undergo HR

a. Parece que $_{CP}$ [o Palmeiras ter perdido o jogo] incomodou muito meu avô
Seems that the Palmeiras have lost the game bother.3SG.PST very my.M grandfather

b. *[O Palmeiras ter perdido o jogo] parece que _ incomodou muito meu avô
the Palmeiras have lost the game seems.3SG that _ bother.3SG.PST very my.M grandfather
"It seems that Palmeiras losing the match bothered my grandfather quite a lot."

Non-DPs should not HR

Number on D is a property of DPs

Hyper raising restrictions in BP: argument PPs

a. Parece que a Julia contou para as meninas o que aconteceu
Seems that the Julia told.3S to the girls the what happen.3SG.PST

b. *Para as meninas parece que a Julia contou _ o que
To the girls seems.3SG that the Julia told.3S the what happen.3SG.PST
aconteceu
"It seems Julia told the girls what happened."

Conclusions and open questions

Take home messages:

Cross clausal movement is not necessarily only driven by clausal properties

There are potential gains in representing discursive information in narrow syntax

Hyper Raising is not exceptional, just part of a broader class of movement

Phase unlocking as a result of c-selection, optionality as a result of hyper-activity

Open questions

- What is the nature of the agree operations driven by δ?
- Why can’t δ simply move the CP into SpecvP when it agrees with it?
- How can HR violate minimality? (Object HR bypasses the embedded subject)
- Why is HR restricted to arguments? (e.g., no DP adjuncts)
- Is SpecvP *always* an A-position?
- Are the two movement steps really the same kind of movement?

Muito obrigado!

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